MAKE THE HUM VISIBLE

A free first investigation.

You hear a hum at night, but an official test says it's fine.

> ### ⚠ Unverified seed — no field trial yet
>
> Tell us what broke: bananas@fancyape.com
>
> **We don't measure how loud your hum is in decibels (dB). A phone can't do that honestly.**

You're done when you know three things: whether the hum changes when you move your bed, whether your phone can see its pitch, and whether it's worth taking further.

Why a test can say "fine"

Many noise tests use a filter called **A-weighting** that turns deep sounds down a lot: the standard meter setting counts a 63 Hz hum as about 26 dB quieter than it is. (Hz measures pitch; low is deep. dB measures strength.) So a low reading can happen even when a deep hum is real, though that doesn't prove a test missed it.

Try tonight. It costs $0.

Steps 1, 2, 3 and 5 take one evening. Step 4 takes about a week. Steps 3–4 matter most for 40–80 Hz hums.

1. **Rule out your own home.** Switch off the fridge, the AC, and then the main breaker for 10 minutes each. If the hum stops, the source is likely inside. Skip this if anyone uses medical equipment.
2. **Measure your bedroom** with a tape measure, or heel-to-toe steps.
3. **Find the pitch your room boosts.** Rooms strengthen certain deep pitches (resonance). Divide 563 by a room length in feet; a 13-foot wall gives about 43 Hz. Many bedrooms have resonances between 40 and 70 Hz. Width and height matter too.
4. **Move your bed.** Deep sound is strongest at walls and corners, so try two or three spots for a few nights. This changes how loud it is where you sleep. It doesn't remove the source. Each morning, write "better," "worse," or "same."
5. **Record 60 seconds** on any phone, in the same spot each night. A free sound-graph app shows the pitch. Many phone microphones filter out very low sound. If your phone shows

nothing but you still hear it, that's not proof it isn't there — write it down with the date and time.

Before you buy new windows

New windows can cost $3,000–8,000 (a rough guess). With two 1/4-inch panes and a 4-inch gap, the weak spot is near 70 Hz. Thinner glass moves it higher. Ask the seller for lab results at **your** pitch ("transmission loss" data), not one score.

If you want a record

Example record: *"A hum near 119 Hz, 12:20 to 5:00 a.m., detected on 5 of 7 nights."*

First, name the person who will read it. If no one will, stop here.

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